

MAE 269: Final Research Report

In this final project you will work in groups of two to three students to write a grant proposal “whitepaper” on a topic of your choice in bioinspired robotics. The project will consist of the following components and deliverables:

- **Project proposal abstract (Due 5/23/2025):** You will turn in a 1-paragraph topic proposal for your project. A google form will be distributed on canvas to collect the proposal abstracts. The paragraph should provide information about the topic area and provide five citations of relevant papers in that area. The document should also include contact information for the members of the team.
- **Literature review (Due 5/30/2025):** Conduct a literature review of your topic area. In a 1+N page document (1 page text, N pages of bibliography) collect and summarize relevant research that has been done in your topic area.
- **Preliminary approach (Due 6/6/2025):** In a 3 page maximum document describe the research approach you would take in your grant. This should be formatted in a manner of describing what activities you would do in your research project. The proposed activities when relevant should be supported by preliminary evidence through modeling, analysis, prior results, etc.
- **Project pitch presentation (Due 6/9/2025):** On the final exam day of class each team will present a pitch for their research project (5 minutes max). The presentation will attempt to argue to the class why your project deserves to be “funded”. The class will provide feedback on each pitch.
- **Final 5-page grant whitepaper (Due 6/11/2025):** Write a 5+N page maximum grant proposal whitepaper. The whitepaper is required to be formatted in IEEE conference format. You can find the IEEE format here <https://www.ieee.org/conferences/publishing/templates.html>. If you have LaTeX problems I advise using OverLeaf. The paper should follow the format of Abstract, introduction and motivation, background and literature review, research approach and preliminary results. Your whitepaper should include references and figures. The references can exceed the page length, but not the main text.

Important Dates

Date	Item
5/23/2025	Project abstract due
5/30/2025	Literature review
6/6/2025	Preliminary approach writeup
6/9/2025	Project pitch presentations
6/11/2025	Final research report